- Experienced Rails coders new to Rails 5 likely use these features and it's worth talking about what fills the same ecological niche in Rails 5.
- Even if you are a new Rails coder, you are likely to encounter older Rails code that uses controller tests, and you probably want to see what is going on.

RSpec for Rails 5 has two test types that are designed to test a single controller action. They are very similar. *Request specs* are basically wrappers around Rails integration tests, and *controller tests* are basically RSpec wrappers around Rails 5 controller tests. (Rails has always used the name "feature tests" for what RSpec calls "controller tests," which is confusing, because RSpec uses "feature tests" to indicate Capybara tests.) The older controller test behavior, should you need it to pull up a legacy codebase, can be reinstated with the rails-controller-testing gem.[1]

The naming gets confusing, but the basic taxonomy of when to use each test is not that bad. Here are the guidelines for RSpec:

- Use a request spec if you're testing the results of a single request to the Rails server, there's no interaction with the user in the test, and you're checking the behavior of the controller action or a side effect of calling the controller action.
- Use an RSpec system spec with Capybara, as described in Chapter 8, *Integration Testing with Capybara and Cucumber*, on page 151, if you're testing something that requires user interaction, such as simulated clicks or multiple page interactions, and if you're testing against the final result on the page.
- Use a system spec with the :js metadata if the integration test requires JavaScript.

If you're used to older versions of RSpec, be advised that I'm explicitly recommending using request specs in place of controller specs, and using system specs in place of feature specs (for reasons described in Chapter 8, *Integration Testing with Capybara and Cucumber*, on page 151).

Minitest and the standard Rails tools have a slightly different decision pattern, which I cover in Chapter 12, *Minitest*, on page 241.

1. https://github.com/rails/rails-controller-testing